Ziyuan Cao

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EDUCATION

Boston Architectural College
January 2024 – May 2026

Master of Landscape Architecture | Studio GPA: 3.8+ — Boston, MA

- BAC Dean's Award ($18,000)
- ASLA Honor Award — Master's Thesis Excellence ($1,500)
- Commendation for Master's Thesis Excellence
- The Edwin T. Steffian Centennial Award ($1,000)
- Sara E. Bourque '14 and David F. Jaquith '69 Landscape Architecture Award ($1,000)

Jiangsu Ocean University
September 2018 – June 2022

Bachelor of Environmental Design — Jiangsu, China

- 2020 Academy Award Spring Competition — Excellence Award (3)
- 2020 Academy Award Spring Competition — Finalist Award (1)
- 2023 Imprint Countryside Creative Design Competition — Jiangsu Provincial Excellence Award
- 2022 University Scholarship

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gateway Office
Boston, MA

Landscape Designer — September 2025 – May 2026

Wildlife Center of the North Coast Site Renewal | Astoria, Oregon

- Developed and coordinated site plans from survey and existing-condition information, coordinating grade changes, circulation, and key landscape nodes for design development.
- Developed outdoor play and learning spaces around children's scale, visibility, and movement; modeled non-motorized play elements to test proportions and relationships with adjacent classrooms.
- Mapped existing vegetation and identified preservation opportunities, coordinating proposed paths and program areas with mature plant material and sensitive site conditions.

Boston Building Resources (BBR) | Community Material Reuse and Environmental Education

- Researched material production, embodied carbon, and reuse pathways; translated findings into material cards, planting guides, and posters for community audiences.
- Designed and assembled reclaimed-material planters, prepared soil and organic-matter mixes, supported seed and greenhouse cultivation, and prepared plants for community distribution or transplanting in biodegradable pots.

Huaxun Taste Decoration Design Engineering Co.
Zhenjiang, China

Landscape Designer — July 2022 – December 2023

- Translated homeowner conversations into courtyard programs and spatial priorities, balancing daily use, privacy, circulation, planting character, and connections between interior rooms and outdoor living areas.
- Compared plants and materials at local markets, nurseries, and stone suppliers, considering availability, character, cost, and constructability when developing selections for each site.
- Monitored on-site paving, planting, and landscape installation, coordinating design details during construction. Independently revisited completed gardens to reflect on seasonal performance, maintenance needs, and mosquito-related concerns.

Zhupin Sichuang Space Design and Engineering Co.
Lianyungang, China

Drafting Assistant — February 2020 – June 2021

- Compiled site information and field observations for residential renewal, municipal public-space, and coastal projects; supported layouts, circulation studies, and landscape-node development in response to site constraints and program needs.
- Produced AutoCAD drawings, SketchUp models, renderings, competition boards, bid graphics, and presentation materials, maintaining consistent information across internal reviews and external communication.

SKILLS

3D Modeling and Parametric Design: Rhino, SketchUp, Grasshopper
Drafting and Presentation: AutoCAD, Photoshop, InDesign, Illustrator, ArcGIS, Microsoft Office
Computer Graphics, Animation, and Virtual Reality: Lumion, Enscape, Twinmotion, D5 Render